OLA SAATHI · CONTEXT · INDIA, 2035

# India’s commute in 2035: two-wheelers are unsafe, cars don’t fit

**Ola’s brief:** in 2035, a product 100M Indians use for the daily commute, not a scooter or motorcycle.

## 1. How India moves

Last measured data, 2023–26

### Vehicles sold in FY26

| | |
|---|---|
| Two-wheelers | **2.14 Cr** |
| Cars, UVs, vans | **0.47 Cr** |

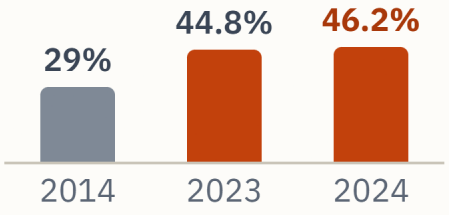
### The market we can reach

| | |
|---|---|
| Urban, 2035 | **67.5 Cr** |
| In 2W homes | **36 Cr+** |
| Our goal | **10 Cr** |

Counted in people. Goal: daily riders by 2042, about 1 in 4 of people in two-wheeler homes

## 2. What’s broken in today’s options

### Two-wheeler: unsafe




Two-wheeler riders' share of road deaths, all India

**1.83 lakh** road deaths in 2025

### Car: doesn't fit their needs

| | |
|---|---|
| ✕ **Can't park** | no spot at home or work |
| ✕ **Too wide** | narrow lanes, galis, markets |
| ✕ **Can't drive** | teens; 60+ are 15% by 2036 |
| ✕ **Stuck** | Bengaluru: 41 min/10 km, peak |
| ✕ **Not just price** | ~1 in 4 richest urban homes |

## 3. 2035: the India we assume

Assumption · evidence today

| | |
|---|---|
| **Fully driverless (L4) in big cities** — Proven abroad: Waymo, Apollo Go | Given |
| **Self-balancing works** — Only prototypes: Lit C-1, Ola Solo | Given |
| **Teens ride alone, as passengers** — Waymo teen accounts (Phoenix, Nashville) | Given |
| **Batteries, sensors cheap** — $108/kWh (2025); lidar ~$200 | High |
| **Cities bigger, older** — 675M urban; 15% aged 60+ | High |

**Reading of the brief:** 100M commuters are two-wheeler families who need a car’s safety but can’t park one, can’t drive one, and can’t waste hours in traffic in one. Ola should build the step up from the scooter: a vehicle that drives itself.

Sources & calculations: docs.google.com/document/d/1DAWUaXmxr3iBHgzKZT5G7QQnEYQiUiSMNXk0-SH97LY

WHO WE BUILD FOR · THEIR COMMUTE IN 2035

# The users: two-wheeler families with no good option in 2035

Traffic, parking

**Rohan, 36**
IT support, Pune

**Commute:** e-scooter, 15 km, ~55 min
**Pains:** peak-hour jams; no parking at home or work
**Options fail:** any car, even self-driving, needs a spot
**Needs:** safe, smaller vehicle to park, daughter's (14) school run

Heat, smog, highway

**Karan, 30**
Sales exec, Gurugram

**Commute:** motorcycle, 25 km on the expressway
**Pains:** extreme heat, winter smog, fast trucks
**Options fail:** bike exposes him; a car needs parking
**Needs:** sealed, cooled, filtered cabin, safe beside trucks

Unsafe at night

**Ananya, 28**
Nurse, Lucknow

**Commute:** two-wheeler taxi, 12 km; late night cabs/auto
**Pains:** dark, empty roads at 2 a.m.; costly late autos
**Options fail:** metro shut at night; cab waits are long and expensive
**Needs:** safe: her own locked, tracked ride

Can't drive

**Meena, 52**
Teacher, Bengaluru

**Commute:** metro, bus, walk: ~75 min
**Pains:** transfers, crowds, the last kilometre on foot
**Options fail:** a car means paying a driver daily
**Needs:** door to door, no driving, low cost

## Every 2035 commute option, against what they need

| Need | E-scooter / bike | Own car | Self-driving car | Metro / bus | Cab / robotaxi |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Crash protection | Low | High | High | High | High |
| Heat and smog | Exposed | Sealed | Sealed | Partial | Sealed |
| Parking | Small | Car space | Car space | None | None |
| Someone must drive | Yes | Yes | No | No | No |
| Time in traffic | Least | Most | Most | Transfers | Most + wait |
| Door to door | Yes | Yes | Yes | No | Yes |
| Safe late at night | No | Yes | Yes | Shut | Long waits |
| Daily cost | Low | High | Highest | Low | Adds up |

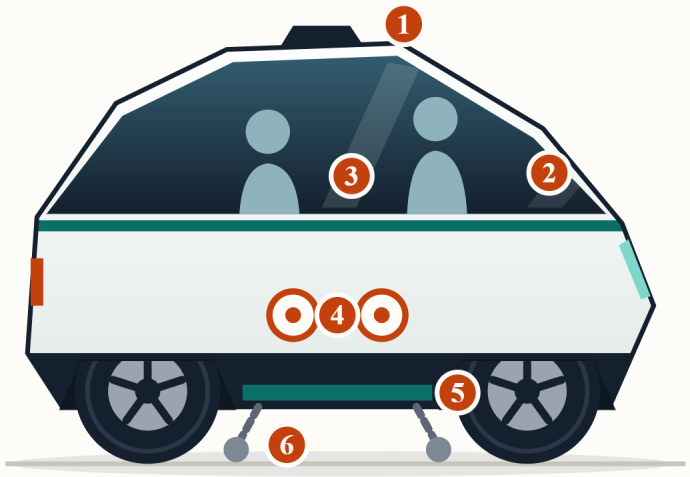
**The gap:** scooters are unsafe, cars need parking and a driver, metro isn't door to door, cabs are car-sized and costly.

Illustrative personas. Sources & calculations: docs.google.com/document/d/1jFv7nr6z_ygmwhwF89GEgrJfUw4mFkcG8FFcrGyJ2Jc

# The product: Ola Saathi, a driverless, self-balancing two-seater

**Solution:** a sealed two-seater, under half a car's footprint, that drives and parks itself, priced from ₹3.6 L, below most cars.

## Prototype: enclosed self-balancing two-wheeler




1. Lidar (laser 3D scanner), cameras, radar
2. Sealed cabin: belts, airbags, AC, air filter
3. 2 seats, one behind the other, keep it 1 m narrow; fold flat
4. Twin gyros (fast-spinning wheels) keep it upright
5. ~13 kWh sealed, swappable battery
6. 4 stabiliser wheels, 2 per side



**Cruise**
on 2 wheels



**Stop**
stabilisers down



**Pothole, water**
stabilisers down



**Fault**
drops, pulls over

| 1.0 × 2.0 m | 2 seats | ~200 km | 80 km/h | ₹3.6–5.1 L |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| < half a car | front + back | with AC | top speed | 2035 price |

## What it does for you

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| **Door to door**<br>to your gate | **Parks itself**<br>no hunt for a spot | **Rides alone**<br>teens, elders; tracked |
| **Clean, cool air**<br>no heat, smog, rain | **Battery swap**<br>swap in minutes | **Safe at night**<br>locked, tracked, SOS |

**Rohan's day:** 07:30 at his gate → 07:45 takes his daughter (14) to school alone, no driver → 09:00 Rohan to office, then parks or earns* → 18:15 picks him up

***Idle 90%+ of the day, so Saathi earns (optional)**







**Safety in layers:** sees (lidar, cameras, radar), balances (gyros, stabilisers), Ola remote help.

Specs are targets. Sources & calculations: docs.google.com/document/d/1fPpO7FcuUWe27GvZ1P03lw4-8uKqRuwuqP5kWKtkILQ

# The choice: why this design, why driverless, why Ola

## Options we compared (scored 1–5, directional)

(5 = best. Cost fit = easiest on the family budget. Ola fit = reuses what Ola has)

| Option | Safety | Cost fit | Space | Family | Ola fit | Total |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Saathi (our pick) | 4 | 3 | 4 | 5 | 4 | 20 |
| Car-sized robotaxi | 5 | 2 | 2 | 4 | 4 | 17 |
| Driverless micro-car | 4 | 2 | 3 | 5 | 2 | 16 |
| Shared route shuttles | 4 | 5 | 4 | 2 | 3 | 18 |
| Covered scooter/3W | 2 | 4 | 4 | 2 | 3 | 15 |

**Trade-off we accept:** Saathi costs more than a scooter and is hardest to build. The others lose on cost and road space (robotaxi), cost and parking (micro-car), door-to-door and kids alone (shuttles) or safety (covered scooter).

**Upside, not scored:** only a driverless Saathi can earn while its owner works.

## Why driverless: far fewer injury crashes




Waymo vs human drivers, 270M+ US miles to June 2026. India must be proven city by city.

**Remote help advises, never drives:** ~70 agents cover ~3,000 Waymo cars.

**Families already trust it:** teens (13–17) ride alone on parent-linked accounts.

## Lessons from earlier attempts, turned into design rules

### Tata Nano, 2009

'Cheapest car' tag hurt it, said Ratan Tata

→ **Sell an upgrade**

### Lit Motors C-1

Gyro balance worked; ~$24k, never produced

→ **Needs factory scale**

### Twizy and Qute

No side windows (Twizy), no AC (Qute)

→ **Sealed, cooled**

**Where L4 (fully driverless) isn't approved yet:** owners drive in manual mode.

## Why Ola is placed to build it

- **R&D:** autonomous, self-balancing two-wheelers (Ola Solo, 2024)
- **Cells:** own cells (2.5 → 20 GWh) cut the costliest part
- **Scale:** Futurefactory, 10M 2W/yr plan
- **Platform:** Ola app/stores to book Saathis; L4 Navigation (Ola Maps)

Sources & calculations: docs.google.com/document/d/1FacQZaDMWdhoAo2Og1uY8HesiL3y8MZiFQiJpabfqlI

AFFORDABILITY · PATH TO 100M · SUCCESS METRICS

# The scale: a price families can pay and 100M users by 2042

### Price ladder, ₹ lakh, 2035 prices



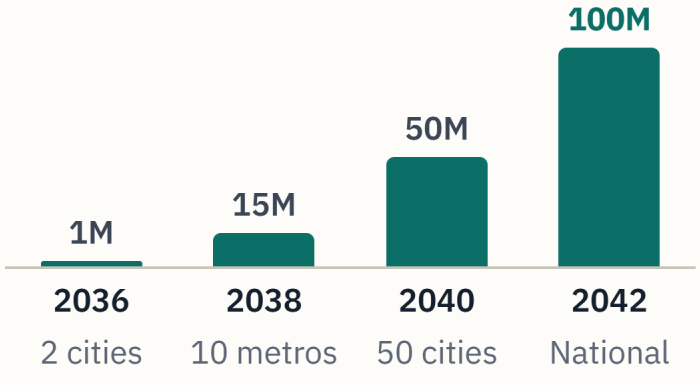

Today's prices × 1.42 (4% a year to 2035); battery at 2035 cell prices

### Monthly cost, ₹, 2035 prices

| Per month | E-scooter | Saathi |
|---|---|---|
| EMI | 4.4k | 7.4k |
| Charging | 0.3k | 0.7k |
| Other rides* | 2.1–3.6k | – |
| Driverless plan | – | 2.1–3.5k |
| Without earning | 6.8–8.3k | 10.2–11.6k |
| Earning (opt.) | – | –3.0–5.0k |
| With earning | 6.8–8.3k | 5.2–8.6k |

*Trips a scooter can't do: school van for kids, cabs or autos in rain, at night, for elders

### 100M Saathi users by 2042




**50M** = 20M owned Saathis × 2.5 people

**48M** = 8M ride-hailing Saathis × 6 people

### Adoption follows cost parity




Share of new sales. China's EV share rose tenfold in five years once costs matched.

**How it starts:** Ola first runs Ola-app Saathis in 2 cities so people can try one; families then buy their own on EMI.

### What must be true

1. Cost near 2W spend, with earning
2. L4 approved, city by city
3. Crash and tip-over tests passed
4. Zero incidents on teen/elder rides
5. ~90 GWh of cells a year at peak

### How we'll know it works

**NORTH STAR**

**Monthly active Saathis**

Saathis with 1+ trip this month
Target 2042: 20M owned + 8M ride-hailing

**SALES AND MARKET**

# Saathis sold a year
% Share in urban 2W + car sales

**IF SALES DROP, CHECK**

App ride → test ride → booking → loan
% Cancellation, Delivery wait, service time, complaints

**QUALITY**

Defect job cards per 10 vehicles, monthly
Avg km between defect job cards

**GUARDRAILS**

Zero tip-overs; injuries/100M km vs 2W

Costs: our estimates. Sources & calculations: docs.google.com/document/d/1duu8ntGt-X3M4f5EfzIZSdcH4RGgBPOaW9oD337tWKk